and bad terrorist strategy, supporting groups such as TLYR whose ideology is divisive. In the end the strategy of the counternarrative to terrorism supports many of those it is intended to defeat ideologically.

This book explores these recent dynamics in Pakistan and how Pakistan arrived where it is now through the voices of the youth – exploring young Pakistanis' views and their relationship to this security state. The ideal Western notion of a social contract in relation to such a security state falls through, as the physical and ideological threat of terrorism trumps freedoms of expression and dissent that ought to be guaranteed to all citizens of Pakistan. The focus is on the voices of young Pakistanis, their views on state accountability (or lack thereof), political literacy/participation and the continued problem of terrorism that is transforming their views of both their country and the world today. With 67 per cent of the population under the age of thirty, Pakistan is uniquely poised to evolve in the next couple of decades, and this book provides a window into how that process is likely to unfold.

Explaining Pakistan

Pakistan has been changing over the last decade. One of the least understood concepts in Pakistan is that of citizenship – the relationship between the state and its people. As politics and daily life in Pakistan is increasingly marked by terrorism and violence, ordinary citizens are questioning the role of the state. When examining Pakistani society three main fault lines are usually used as a prism of analysis and as reasons for the country's current socio-economic problems: ethnic/linguistic or provincial identities, sectarian identities and the army versus the rest of the population. While all these fault lines do exist and indeed divide Pakistani society, this book argues that it is state–society relations that need to be examined and better understood in order to explain how Pakistan is evolving today. However, in order to understand state–society relations, it is important to briefly examine the three main fault lines that have shaped Pakistan Studies for the last few decades and see what role the state plays in each one of them (Lall 2012).

Ethnic/linguistic lines – Pakistan through the prism of regionalism

Pakistan was born with a temporary sense of national identity, many suspending their regional, ethnic and linguistic identities during the period immediately